

IIM Mumbai - MBA in Creative Industries (Media & Entertainment)

Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 288

Question Distribution

- **VARC:** 22 questions (suggested time 36 min)
- **DILR:** 18 questions (suggested time 32 min)
- **QA:** 22 questions (suggested time 36 min)
- **General Awareness:** 10 questions (suggested time 16 min)
- Total: 72 questions | MCQ 72 | TITA (non-MCQ) 0

Marking Scheme

- MCQ: +4 for a correct answer, -1 for a wrong answer.
- Unanswered questions: no marks awarded or deducted.

General Instructions

- Read each question carefully before attempting.
- For MCQs, choose the single most appropriate option (A-D, or A-E where shown).
- Total duration is 2 Hours; the suggested per-section times are shown above.
- Sections may be attempted in any order; manage your time across all sections.

This is the answer-marked verification copy (correct option in green, with solution) and mirrors the content of the upload CSV.

Section: VARC (suggested 36 min)

Instructions (VARC-RC1): study the shared passage below and answer its 4 question(s).

For most of the twentieth century, film was treated as a disposable commodity rather than a cultural inheritance. Studios routinely melted down old prints to recover the silver in their emulsion, and the nitrate stock on which early cinema was shot decayed, caught fire, or was simply discarded once a film had finished its commercial run. By some estimates, the majority of movies made before 1930 no longer survive in any form. It was only in the latter half of the century, as scholars began to treat cinema as an art with a history worth preserving, that systematic archiving took hold.

Modern restoration is a painstaking and expensive craft. Technicians scan surviving prints frame by frame, then labour to remove scratches, correct faded colour, and reconstruct missing sequences from whatever fragments can be located in archives around the world. The goal, most restorers insist, is not to improve on the original but to return it as closely as possible to the state its makers intended. This principle is more contentious than it sounds. When a director's intentions were never documented, or when the only surviving print differs from the version audiences first saw, the restorer must make interpretive choices that shade into authorship.

Digital tools have made these choices sharper. Software can now invent plausible detail where none survives, smoothing a film into something crisper than any print ever looked. Purists warn that such enhancement risks producing a counterfeit, a version that never existed and that misleads viewers about how the film was actually experienced. Others counter that a pristine reconstruction, honestly labelled, does more to keep a film alive than a faithful copy no one will watch. The debate turns, ultimately, on whether preservation means guarding an object or sustaining an experience.

Q1. [VARC-RC1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

According to the passage, all of the following contributed to the loss of early films EXCEPT:

- A) the discarding of prints once a film's commercial run had ended
- B) the natural decay and flammability of the nitrate film stock
- C) the transfer of prints to public archives for safekeeping ✓
- D) the melting of prints to recover silver from their emulsion

Answer: C) the transfer of prints to public archives for safekeeping

Solution: The passage lists melting prints for silver, nitrate decay and fire, and discarding after a commercial run as causes of loss, so those three are supported. Transferring prints to public archives for safekeeping is never named as a cause; if anything it preserves films, making it the unsupported option.

Q2. [VARC-RC1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which of the following best expresses the central idea of the passage?

- A) Digital software has at last resolved the technical problems that plagued restoration.
- B) Restoring a film is mainly a matter of erasing scratches and correcting faded colour.
- C) Early studios were uniquely careless custodians compared with the keepers of other arts.
- D) Film preservation forces hard choices between fidelity and keeping works watchable. ✓

Answer: D) Film preservation forces hard choices between fidelity and keeping works watchable.

Solution: The passage moves from the historical loss of films to the modern craft of restoration and its dilemmas, ending on whether preservation guards an object or sustains an experience. The idea that preservation forces choices between fidelity and watchability captures that arc. Claiming software resolved everything, that studios were uniquely careless, or that restoration is merely fixing scratches each seizes on a detail while missing the central tension.

Q3. [VARC-RC1 · mcsc · diff 1]

It can most reasonably be inferred that the author regards digital enhancement as:

- A) an unqualified advance that every serious film archive should now adopt
- B) a powerful tool whose benefits depend on how honestly it is used ✓
- C) a passing fashion likely to be abandoned by future restorers
- D) a fraud that responsible restorers ought to refuse to use outright

Answer: B) a powerful tool whose benefits depend on how honestly it is used

Solution: The author presents both the purist warning and the counter-argument, and highlights that a reconstruction being 'honestly labelled' is what makes it defensible. That balance implies the tool is powerful but its value hinges on honest use. Calling it an unqualified advance ignores the purist warning, calling it an outright fraud ignores the counter-argument, and predicting it will be abandoned finds no basis in the text.

Q4. [VARC-RC1 · mcsc · diff 1]

The author's treatment of the restoration debate is best described as:

- A) dismissive, treating the whole controversy as a distraction from real work
- B) even-handed, laying out competing positions without endorsing either side ✓
- C) nostalgic, mourning a lost golden age of craftsmanship now gone for good
- D) alarmed, warning that digital tools are destroying our cinematic heritage

Answer: B) even-handed, laying out competing positions without endorsing either side

Solution: The author gives the purist and the pragmatic views equal weight and closes by framing the issue as an open question rather than settling it, which reads as even-handed. There is no dismissal of the controversy, no alarmed prediction of destroyed heritage, and no mourning of a lost golden age; those tones overstate a stance the passage never takes.

Instructions (VARC-RC2): study the shared passage below and answer its 4 question(s).

When streaming platforms overtook physical sales as the music industry's main source of revenue, they were hailed as the cure for piracy. Listeners who had grown used to downloading songs for free could now reach almost every recording ever made for a modest monthly fee, and the money, in theory, would flow back to the artists who made the music. A decade on, that promise looks more complicated. The industry's overall revenues have indeed recovered, but the way streaming distributes those revenues has provoked lasting resentment among the musicians it was meant to reward.

The core of the problem lies in how platforms pool and divide their subscription income. Rather than paying each listener's fee to the specific artists that listener actually plays, most services add all subscriptions into a single pot and share it out in proportion to each artist's share of total streams across the whole platform. Under this model, a handful of chart-topping performers capture the overwhelming majority of the pool, while the long tail of niche and emerging artists receives fractions of a cent per play. A musician with a devoted but small audience may find that their most loyal fans effectively subsidise stars those fans never listen to.

Reformers have proposed a user-centric model, in which each subscriber's fee is divided only among the artists that subscriber streams. Studies suggest this would modestly benefit smaller acts without greatly harming the biggest names. Yet the major labels, whose catalogues dominate the charts, have little incentive to champion a change that would trim their advantage, and the platforms are wary of the accounting complexity it would introduce. The technology that made abundance possible, it turns out, did nothing to settle the older question of how fairly its rewards should be shared.

Q5. [VARC-RC2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

According to the passage, how do most streaming services currently divide subscription income?

- A) They pool all fees and split them by each artist's share of total plays ✓
- B) They pay each subscriber's fee only to the artists that subscriber streams
- C) They divide the income equally among every artist available on the service
- D) They award fixed monthly sums to artists based on their chart positions

Answer: A) They pool all fees and split them by each artist's share of total plays

Solution: The second paragraph states that most services add all subscriptions into one pot and share it by each artist's share of total streams, which the pooling-and-splitting option restates. Paying each subscriber's fee only to the artists they stream is the reformers' user-centric alternative, not current practice, while fixed chart-based sums and equal division are never described.

Q6. [VARC-RC2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The passage is primarily concerned with:

- A) how the major record labels came to dominate the singles charts over time
- B) why listeners now prefer a monthly fee to buying physical recordings
- C) how streaming revives revenue yet shares it unfairly among artists ✓
- D) why streaming has failed to end the piracy of recorded popular music

Answer: C) how streaming revives revenue yet shares it unfairly among artists

Solution: The passage grants that revenues have recovered but centres on the resentment caused by how that money is distributed, closing on the unsettled question of fair reward. The revenue-revived-yet-unfairly-shared option captures both halves. Piracy, label dominance, and listener preferences appear only as background details, not as the passage's main concern.

Q7. [VARC-RC2 · mcsc · diff 1]

Which of the following can most reasonably be inferred about the user-centric model?

- A) It would leave the incomes of small niche artists essentially unchanged
- B) Its adoption is blocked more by competing interests than by weak evidence ✓
- C) It has already been quietly embraced by the largest recording labels
- D) It would sharply reduce the earnings of the most popular chart performers

Answer: B) Its adoption is blocked more by competing interests than by weak evidence

Solution: The passage says studies support the model, yet labels lack incentive to back it and platforms fear the accounting complexity, so the obstacle lies in interests and practicality rather than in evidence. That the biggest names would be sharply cut is denied by 'without greatly harming' them; that labels embrace it contradicts their reluctance; and unchanged niche incomes contradicts the noted modest benefit to smaller acts.

Q8. [VARC-RC2 · mcsc · diff 1]

The author's attitude toward the original promise of streaming is best described as:

- A) skeptical, noting that recovered revenue masks an unfair distribution ✓
- B) hostile, condemning each streaming platform as a deliberate fraud on artists
- C) indifferent, treating the shift as a routine change in technology
- D) enthusiastic, crediting streaming with rescuing a collapsing industry

Answer: A) skeptical, noting that recovered revenue masks an unfair distribution

Solution: The author calls the promise 'more complicated' and stresses that headline recovery hides an unfair split, a skeptical rather than celebratory stance. Enthusiasm ignores the resentment the passage documents, indifference ignores its clear concern with fairness, and hostility overstates the measured tone, since the author never accuses platforms of deliberate fraud.

Instructions (VARC-RC3): study the shared passage below and answer its 4 question(s).

Video games tell stories in a way no older medium can: the audience does not merely watch events unfold but participates in bringing them about. A novelist decides exactly what happens on each page, and a filmmaker fixes every shot in a set order. A game designer, by contrast, must build a world in which the player's own choices help shape the tale. This shift from telling a story to enabling one is the defining challenge of narrative design in games.

The freedom that makes games distinctive also creates a tension. The more genuine control a player is given, the harder it becomes for designers to guarantee a satisfying dramatic shape. A story that can unfold in a thousand ways risks feeling shapeless, while one that funnels every player toward the same ending can make their choices feel like an illusion. Designers speak of this as the conflict between agency, the player's sense that their decisions matter, and authorship, the crafted arc that gives a story its emotional force.

Different games strike the balance differently. Some offer branching plots in which early decisions lead to genuinely distinct conclusions, at the cost of enormous extra writing that most players will never see. Others keep a fixed main storyline but let players colour it with optional side quests and small choices that alter tone rather than outcome. A few abandon authored plot almost entirely, scattering fragments of story through an environment for players to assemble in their own order and at their own pace.

None of these approaches is simply correct. Each trades away something to gain something else, and the right choice depends on what a particular game is trying to make its players feel. What unites them is the recognition that in an interactive medium, the player is never only an audience.

Q9. [VARC-RC3 · mcsc · diff 0]

According to the passage, what most distinguishes video games from novels and films?

- A) They rely on moving visual images instead of printed words to tell a story
- B) Their plots are fixed in advance by a single author or a single director
- C) The stories they tell are usually longer and more complex than those of films
- D) The audience helps bring about events rather than only witnessing them ✓

Answer: D) The audience helps bring about events rather than only witnessing them

Solution: The opening lines set games apart by saying the audience does not merely watch but participates in bringing events about, unlike a novelist or filmmaker who fixes everything in advance. Greater length, reliance on images, and plots fixed by one author are not the distinction drawn; the last, in fact, describes the novels and films the passage contrasts with games.

Q10. [VARC-RC3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The passage mentions all of the following as ways games handle storytelling EXCEPT:

- A) offering branching plots whose early choices lead to genuinely distinct endings
- B) keeping a fixed main story while adding optional side quests that alter tone
- C) scattering fragments of story through a world for players to assemble
- D) letting players rewrite the game's dialogue to suit their own preferences ✓

Answer: D) letting players rewrite the game's dialogue to suit their own preferences

Solution: The third paragraph names branching plots with distinct endings, a fixed storyline coloured by optional side quests, and story fragments scattered for players to assemble, so those three are supported. Letting players rewrite the dialogue is never described, which makes it the option the passage does not mention.

Q11. [VARC-RC3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which statement about narrative design does the passage most support?

- A) Optional side quests usually change a game's final ending significantly
- B) Greater player freedom tends to make a shaped ending harder to ensure ✓
- C) Branching plots are always the most satisfying form of game narrative
- D) Fragmentary, scattered storytelling appeals to the very widest audience

Answer: B) Greater player freedom tends to make a shaped ending harder to ensure

Solution: The second paragraph states that the more control a player is given, the harder designers find it to guarantee a satisfying dramatic shape, which the freedom-versus-shaped-ending statement restates. The passage denies that any one approach is best, says side quests alter tone rather than outcome, and never claims scattered storytelling has the broadest appeal.

Q12. [VARC-RC3 · mcsc · diff 1]

The author concludes the passage chiefly in order to:

- A) stress that no approach is best, since each trades off against the others ✓
- B) warn designers against giving players too much freedom in a story
- C) predict that games will soon surpass novels as a form of art
- D) argue that branching narratives will eventually replace all fixed storylines

Answer: A) stress that no approach is best, since each trades off against the others

Solution: The final paragraph declares that none of the approaches is simply correct, that each trades something away, and that the right one depends on the intended feeling, so its purpose is to stress that no single method is best. It does not forecast branching plots replacing fixed ones, caution against too much freedom, or predict games overtaking novels.

Q13. [VARC-JUMBLE-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The four sentences below, when correctly ordered, form a coherent paragraph.

- (1) For decades the negatives sat forgotten in studio vaults, slowly decaying in the heat.
- (2) Early cinema survives today only in fragments, much of it lost to simple neglect.
- (3) When technicians finally reopened the cans, they found images no living audience had seen.
- (4) A few studios have since made the painstaking recovery of these reels a point of pride.

Select the correct order.

- A) 1, 2, 3, 4
- B) 3, 2, 1, 4
- C) 2, 1, 3, 4 ✓
- D) 2, 3, 1, 4

Answer: C) 2, 1, 3, 4

Solution: Sentence 2 opens with the general claim that early cinema survives only in fragments, sentence 1 explains the decades of decay in the vaults, sentence 3 gives the moment of rediscovery, and sentence 4 closes with the studios' pride in recovery, giving the order 2, 1, 3, 4. Beginning with 'For decades the negatives' strands that clause with no earlier reference to the films, so orders starting on sentence 1 or 3 read as mid-thought.

Q14. [VARC-JUMBLE-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The four sentences below, when correctly ordered, form a coherent paragraph.

- (1) Vinyl, long dismissed as a dead format, has quietly returned to the shelves of record shops.
- (2) Collectors argue that the warmth of analogue sound is well worth the inconvenience.
- (3) Streaming made music weightless, infinite and, to some ears, oddly disposable.
- (4) The revival is less about fidelity, then, than about owning something you can hold.

Select the correct order.

- A) 1, 3, 2, 4
- B) 3, 1, 2, 4 ✓
- C) 1, 2, 3, 4
- D) 3, 2, 1, 4

Answer: B) 3, 1, 2, 4

Solution: Sentence 3 sets up the contrast by casting streaming as disposable, sentence 1 introduces vinyl's return as the answer to it, sentence 2 gives the collectors' defence, and sentence 4 draws the closing conclusion about ownership, giving 3, 1, 2, 4. Opening on sentence 1 loses the streaming contrast that the concluding 'The revival' in sentence 4 depends on.

Q15. [VARC-JUMBLE-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The four sentences below, when correctly ordered, form a coherent paragraph.

- (1) Independent developers, working in tiny teams, began releasing games no major publisher would fund.
- (2) For years the industry had chased ever bigger budgets and ever safer sequels.
- (3) Some of these small titles went on to outsell the blockbusters they were meant to rival.
- (4) Freed from corporate caution, they experimented with strange stories and stranger mechanics.

Select the correct order.

- A) 2, 1, 4, 3 ✓
- B) 1, 2, 4, 3
- C) 2, 1, 3, 4
- D) 1, 2, 3, 4

Answer: A) 2, 1, 4, 3

Solution: Sentence 2 establishes the industry's chase for big budgets, sentence 1 introduces the indie developers who broke from it, sentence 4 explains how, 'freed from corporate caution', they experimented, and sentence 3 reports that some outsold the blockbusters, giving 2, 1, 4, 3. Placing sentence 3 before sentence 4 announces the outcome before the experiments that produced it.

Q16. [VARC-JUMBLE-4 · mcsc · diff 1]

The four sentences below, when correctly ordered, form a coherent paragraph.

- (1) The result is a strange democracy in which a masterpiece and a selfie compete for the same glance.
- (2) Museums once asked their visitors to stand still and to look for a long time.
- (3) Now those same visitors move through the galleries at the pace of a feed, phones raised.
- (4) Yet curators remain reluctant to ban the very cameras that also fill their halls.

Select the correct order.

- A) 3, 2, 1, 4
- B) 2, 3, 1, 4 ✓
- C) 2, 3, 4, 1
- D) 2, 1, 3, 4

Answer: B) 2, 3, 1, 4

Solution: Sentence 2 fixes the past with 'once', sentence 3 marks the shift with 'Now', sentence 1 states the consequence with 'The result', and sentence 4 adds the closing twist with 'Yet', giving 2, 3, 1, 4. Ending on sentence 1 leaves the paragraph closing on a stated consequence rather than the curators' unresolved reluctance, and putting sentence 1 straight after sentence 2 gives 'The result' no cause.

Q17. [VARC-ODD-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Four of the five sentences below belong together; one does not.

- (1) A well-drawn protagonist gives the audience someone whose fate they cannot help tracking.
- (2) Conflict is the engine that keeps a plot moving from one scene into the next.
- (3) Dialogue does its best work when it reveals character without ever announcing it.
- (4) A distributor's marketing budget often decides how many screens a film opens on.
- (5) A satisfying ending quietly pays off the promises the opening scene had made.

Which sentence is the odd one out?

- A) Sentence 2
- B) Sentence 1
- C) Sentence 4 ✓
- D) Sentence 3
- E) Sentence 5

Answer: C) Sentence 4

Solution: Sentences 1, 2, 3 and 5 each describe an element of storytelling craft, namely the protagonist, conflict, dialogue and the ending. The sentence about a distributor's marketing budget deciding how many screens a film opens on concerns release economics rather than craft, so it is the misfit.

Q18. [VARC-ODD-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Four of the five sentences below belong together; one does not.

- (1) A low camera angle can make a character loom, suddenly powerful, over the frame.
- (2) Slow fades between shots let a scene breathe and signal the quiet passing of time.
- (3) A rights clearance must be secured before any archived footage can be legally reused.
- (4) Desaturated colour tends to drain a scene of its warmth and leave it feeling bleak.
- (5) Handheld camerawork lends a jittery rawness that a locked-off tripod never could.

Which sentence is the odd one out?

- A) Sentence 3 ✓
- B) Sentence 1
- C) Sentence 4
- D) Sentence 5
- E) Sentence 2

Answer: A) Sentence 3

Solution: Sentences 1, 2, 4 and 5 all describe visual techniques that shape a film's mood, namely camera angle, fades, colour and handheld movement. The sentence about securing a rights clearance before reusing footage is a legal and contractual matter, so it does not belong.

Q19. [VARC-ODD-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Four of the five sentences below belong together; one does not.

- (1) A radio drama asks its listeners to build every set and face inside their own heads.
- (2) The intimacy of a voice in headphones can feel closer than any image on a screen.
- (3) Sound designers layer footsteps and wind to place a listener firmly inside a scene.
- (4) A single pause in the narration can carry more tension than a page of description.
- (5) Billboards rely on one bold image glimpsed for a second from a passing car.

Which sentence is the odd one out?

- A) Sentence 3
- B) Sentence 5 ✓
- C) Sentence 2
- D) Sentence 4
- E) Sentence 1

Answer: B) Sentence 5

Solution: Sentences 1 to 4 all describe the power of audio storytelling, namely the radio drama, the intimate voice, sound design and the loaded pause. The sentence about billboards glimpsed for a second from a passing car concerns a purely visual medium, so it is the odd one out.

Q20. [VARC-SUMMARY-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Film festivals present themselves as showcases for bold, uncommercial work, yet the economics tell a subtler story. A prize at a major festival can turn an unknown title into a distributor's target overnight, and the buzz of a premiere is a marketing asset that money alone cannot buy. Filmmakers, in turn, tailor their work and their timing to the festival calendar, chasing the validation that unlocks funding for the next project. Far from standing apart from the market, the festival has become one of its most efficient engines.

Which option best summarises the paragraph?

- A) Filmmakers increasingly schedule their productions around the festival calendar to earn the approval of critics and juries.
- B) Festivals ought to return to their founding mission of promoting difficult, uncommercial work rather than publicity.
- C) A prize at a major festival can turn an unknown title into a distributor's target and win it public attention.
- D) Though festivals seem to reward art over commerce, they in fact work as a marketplace that shapes and sells films. ✓

Answer: D) Though festivals seem to reward art over commerce, they in fact work as a marketplace that shapes and sells films.

Solution: The paragraph's point is that festivals, despite their arty image, function as an efficient part of the film market, shaping what gets made and helping sell it. The single-prize option is only one supporting detail, the scheduling option captures a second detail rather than the whole argument, and the 'ought to return' option is a prescription the text never makes.

Q21. [VARC-SUMMARY-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Recommendation algorithms promise to free listeners from the tyranny of the mainstream, surfacing obscure artists a radio station would never play. In practice the effect is often the reverse. Because the systems learn from what most people already enjoy, they tend to funnel millions of users toward the same safe, familiar tracks. The obscure song still exists in the catalogue, but the machinery is built to bury it. What looks like infinite choice can quietly narrow into a single well-worn groove.

Which option best summarises the paragraph?

- A) Recommendation algorithms learn from collective behaviour, so their suggestions steadily improve as more people use them.
- B) Listeners would discover far more unusual music if they simply ignored the recommendations their apps keep pushing.
- C) Streaming catalogues now hold millions of obscure songs that radio stations were never willing to play at all.
- D) Music recommendation systems promise to broaden taste but tend to steer listeners toward the same popular tracks. ✓

Answer: D) Music recommendation systems promise to broaden taste but tend to steer listeners toward the same popular tracks.

Solution: The paragraph argues that recommendation systems claim to widen taste yet actually herd listeners toward the same popular tracks, narrowing real choice. The obscure-catalogue option is a supporting detail, the 'ignore the recommendations' option is advice the text never gives, and the claim that the suggestions simply improve with use reverses the paragraph's central point.

Q22. [VARC-SUMMARY-3 · mcsc · diff 1]

The idea of the lone author has always been something of a convenient fiction, but franchise cinema has made its emptiness impossible to ignore. A modern blockbuster is assembled by hundreds of hands, its script revised by committee, its images finished by studios on three continents, its shape set as much by a release schedule as by any vision. To ask who its author is may simply be the wrong question. The more honest one is whether authorship, as we have understood it, describes anything real about how such films come to exist.

Which option best summarises the paragraph?

- A) Films would surely be better if one strong creative vision guided them instead of a corporate release schedule.
- B) Modern blockbuster scripts are revised by committees and their images finished by studios spread across three continents.
- C) Franchise filmmaking, built by many hands, casts doubt on whether the idea of a single author still means anything. ✓
- D) The notion of the lone author was always a fiction, though only now has the film industry admitted it openly.

Answer: C) Franchise filmmaking, built by many hands, casts doubt on whether the idea of a single author still means anything.

Solution: The paragraph uses franchise cinema to argue that the single-author idea no longer describes how such films are made, and it questions whether authorship means anything real. The committees-and-continents option is a supporting detail, the 'always a fiction' option overstates one opening clause, and the call for a single guiding vision is a prescription the text deliberately avoids.

Section: DILR (suggested 32 min)

Instructions (DILR-1): study the shared data below and answer its 3 question(s).

At an independent film festival, five feature films are shown one after another in five consecutive screening slots, from Slot 1 (the earliest) to Slot 5 (the latest). Each film takes exactly one slot. The five films are Amber, Comet, Drift, Ember and Frost.

- Amber is screened in the slot immediately after Ember. - Frost is screened in an earlier slot than Comet, with exactly two films screened between them. - Drift is screened before Ember, but not in the slot immediately before Ember.

Q23. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which film is screened in Slot 1?

- A) Ember
- B) Frost
- C) Amber
- D) Drift ✓

Answer: D) Drift

Solution: Frost and Comet must be three slots apart with Frost earlier, so they sit at Slots 2 and 5 (a placement at 1 and 4 leaves no valid consecutive Ember-Amber pair). That fixes Ember at 3, Amber at 4, and forces Drift into Slot 1, since Drift must precede Ember without being immediately before it. Frost is at Slot 2, not Slot 1, and Ember and Amber sit deeper in the order, so each of those is a wrong pick.

Q24. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which film is screened in the slot immediately before Comet?

- A) Amber ✓
- B) Frost
- C) Ember
- D) Drift

Answer: A) Amber

Solution: The order is fully determined as Drift, Frost, Ember, Amber, Comet across Slots 1 to 5. Comet occupies Slot 5, so the film immediately before it is Amber in Slot 4. Ember sits at Slot 3, Frost at Slot 2 and Drift at Slot 1, so none of those is adjacent to Comet on the earlier side.

Q25. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

How many films are screened between Ember and Comet?

- A) One ✓
- B) None
- C) Two
- D) Three

Answer: A) One

Solution: In the settled order Drift, Frost, Ember, Amber, Comet, Ember is at Slot 3 and Comet at Slot 5. Only Amber, at Slot 4, sits strictly between them, so the count is exactly one. Counting Amber and one endpoint gives the two trap, while three or none ignore the actual gap of two slots.

Instructions (DILR-2): study the shared data below and answer its 4 question(s).

Ad Revenue by Digital Platform (Rs crore)

Platform	Q1	Q2	Q3
Vibe	120	150	180
Pulse	90	120	150
Reel	60	75	90
Spark	30	45	60

Q26. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which platform earned the highest total ad revenue across the three quarters?

- A) Vibe ✓
- B) Reel
- C) Pulse
- D) Spark

Answer: A) Vibe

Solution: Summing each row gives Vibe $120+150+180 = 450$, Pulse $90+120+150 = 360$, Reel $60+75+90 = 225$ and Spark $30+45+60 = 135$. Vibe's 450 is the largest, so Vibe leads. Pulse looks close if you only glance at Q3, but its three-quarter total trails Vibe by 90.

Q27. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

What was the total ad revenue earned by all four platforms in Q2?

- A) Rs 390 crore ✓
- B) Rs 300 crore
- C) Rs 360 crore
- D) Rs 480 crore

Answer: A) Rs 390 crore

Solution: Adding the Q2 column gives $150+120+75+45 = 390$ crore. The 300 crore trap is the Q1 column total, the 480 crore trap is the Q3 column total, and 360 crore is Pulse's own three-quarter total rather than a column sum.

Q28. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

By what percentage did Vibe's ad revenue grow from Q1 to Q3?

- A) 60%
- B) 33.33%
- C) 50% ✓
- D) 25%

Answer: C) 50%

Solution: Vibe rose from 120 in Q1 to 180 in Q3, a rise of 60 on a base of 120, so $60/120 = 50\%$. The 33.33% trap divides the 60 rise by the final 180 instead of the base. The 25% and 60% figures come from mismatched bases and are not the correct growth.

Q29. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Pulse's Q3 revenue was approximately what share of the total Q3 revenue of all platforms?

- A) 33.33%
- B) 37.50%
- C) 30.00%
- D) 31.25% ✓

Answer: D) 31.25%

Solution: Total Q3 revenue is $180+150+90+60 = 480$, and Pulse's Q3 figure is 150, giving $150/480 = 31.25\%$. The 37.50% trap uses Vibe's 180 as the numerator, and the 33.33% trap divides by Vibe's row total of 450 instead of the Q3 column total.

Instructions (DILR-3): study the shared data below and answer its 4 question(s).

Genre-wise Film Releases and Ratings (last year)

Genre	Releases	Avg Rating (of 10)	Box Office (Rs crore)
Drama	14	7.5	300
Comedy	15	6.0	375
Thriller	8	8.5	200
Romance	12	6.5	240
Action	6	7.0	180

Q30. [DILR-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

How many films were released in total across all five genres?

- A) 51
- B) 55 ✓
- C) 45
- D) 50

Answer: B) 55

Solution: Adding the Releases column gives $14+15+8+12+6 = 55$ films. The 50 and 51 traps come from dropping or miscounting one genre, while 45 omits the Comedy row entirely. Only the full sum of all five rows gives 55.

Q31. [DILR-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which genre recorded the highest average rating?

- A) Thriller ✓
- B) Comedy
- C) Drama
- D) Romance

Answer: A) Thriller

Solution: Scanning the Avg Rating column, Thriller's 8.5 is the highest, ahead of Drama at 7.5 and Romance at 6.5. Comedy has the most releases but the lowest rating at 6.0, so picking it confuses volume with quality. The rating column alone settles it in Thriller's favour.

Q32. [DILR-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

What was the average box-office collection per Comedy film?

- A) Rs 20 crore
- B) Rs 15 crore
- C) Rs 25 crore ✓
- D) Rs 30 crore

Answer: C) Rs 25 crore

Solution: Comedy earned 375 crore across 15 releases, so the average is $375/15 = 25$ crore per film. The 20 crore trap divides by Drama's 14 releases instead, and 30 crore comes from using 450 as the total. Only 375 over 15 gives the correct 25 crore.

Q33. [DILR-3 · mcsc · diff 1]

The engagement score of a genre is its number of releases multiplied by its average rating. Which genre has the highest engagement score?

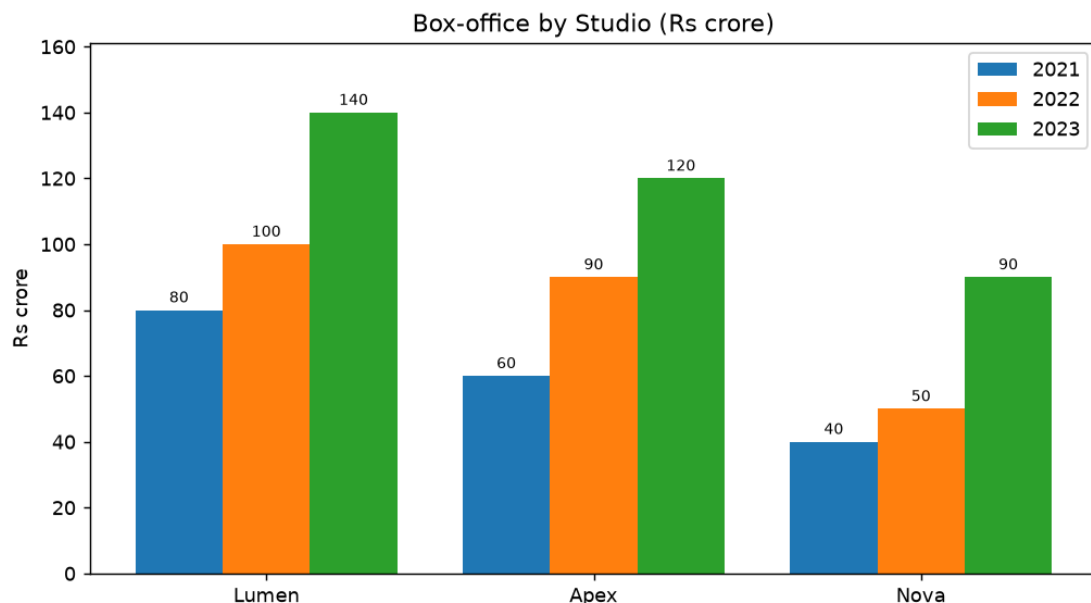
- A) Comedy
- B) Thriller
- C) Drama ✓
- D) Romance

Answer: C) Drama

Solution: Engagement scores are Drama 14 times 7.5 = 105, Comedy 15 times 6.0 = 90, Thriller 8 times 8.5 = 68, Romance 12 times 6.5 = 78 and Action 6 times 7.0 = 42. Drama's 105 tops the list. Comedy has the most releases and Thriller the best rating, but neither wins once the two factors are combined.

Instructions (DILR-4): study the shared data below and answer its 4 question(s).

Box-office collections (Rs crore) by studio across three years.



Q34. [DILR-4 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

What was the combined 2023 box-office collection of all three studios?

- A) Rs 320 crore
- B) Rs 180 crore
- C) Rs 240 crore
- D) Rs 350 crore ✓

Answer: D) Rs 350 crore

Solution: Reading the 2023 bars, Lumen 140, Apex 120 and Nova 90 sum to 350 crore. The 240 crore trap is the 2022 total and 180 crore is the 2021 total, while 320 crore is Lumen's own three-year total rather than the 2023 sum across studios.

Q35. [DILR-4 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which studio collected the most across the three years, and what was that total?

- A) Lumen (Rs 350 crore)
- B) Nova (Rs 180 crore)
- C) Lumen (Rs 320 crore) ✓
- D) Apex (Rs 270 crore)

Answer: C) Lumen (Rs 320 crore)

Solution: Three-year totals are Lumen $80+100+140 = 320$, Apex $60+90+120 = 270$ and Nova $40+50+90 = 180$. Lumen's 320 crore is the highest. The Lumen 350 crore trap mixes in the 2023 all-studio total, while the Apex and Nova options are their own smaller totals.

Q36. [DILR-4 · mcsc · diff 1]

By what percentage did Nova's collection grow from 2021 to 2023?

- A) 125% ✓
- B) 100%
- C) 55.56%
- D) 80%

Answer: A) 125%

Solution: Nova rose from 40 in 2021 to 90 in 2023, a rise of 50 on a base of 40, so $50/40 = 125\%$. The 55.56% trap divides the 50 rise by the final 90 instead of the base, and 100% would need a doubling to 80. Only 50 over 40 yields 125%.

Q37. [DILR-4 · mcsc · diff 1]

By what percentage did the combined collection of all three studios rise from 2021 to 2023?

- A) 170%
- B) 100%
- C) 48.57%
- D) 94.44% ✓

Answer: D) 94.44%

Solution: The all-studio total went from $80+60+40 = 180$ in 2021 to $140+120+90 = 350$ in 2023, a rise of 170 on a base of 180, so $170/180 = 94.44\%$. The 48.57% trap divides the 170 rise by the final 350, and 170% wrongly reads the raw rise of 170 as a percentage. Only 170 over 180 gives 94.44%.

Instructions (DILR-5): study the shared data below and answer its 3 question(s).

A studio releases four films, Nova, Onyx, Pulse and Quill, over four consecutive weeks, from Week 1 to Week 4. Each film is released in exactly one week, and each is distributed in exactly one region, chosen from North, South, East and West. No two films share a week, and no two films share a region.

- Onyx is distributed in the East, Nova in the South, and Quill in the West. - Pulse is released in Week 3. - Nova is released in the week immediately before Pulse. - The film distributed in the West is released in a later week than the film distributed in the East.

Q38. [DILR-5 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In which week is Onyx released?

- A) Week 1 ✓
- B) Week 3
- C) Week 4
- D) Week 2

Answer: A) Week 1

Solution: Pulse is in Week 3 and Nova, immediately before it, is in Week 2. That leaves Weeks 1 and 4 for Onyx and Quill. Since Quill is in the West and Onyx in the East, and the West film is released later than the East film, Quill takes Week 4 and Onyx takes Week 1. Week 2 belongs to Nova and Week 3 to Pulse, so those are wrong.

Q39. [DILR-5 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which film is distributed in the North region?

- A) Quill
- B) Pulse ✓
- C) Onyx
- D) Nova

Answer: B) Pulse

Solution: Three regions are stated directly: Onyx in the East, Nova in the South and Quill in the West. Since every film takes a different region and only North remains, Pulse must be the North film by elimination. Onyx, Nova and Quill are each already tied to another region, so none of them can be the answer.

Q40. [DILR-5 · mcsc · diff 1]

Which one of the following statements is true?

- A) Pulse comes out in a later week than Quill does now.
- B) The South film is released before the North film. ✓
- C) The East-region film is released during Week 2 here.
- D) Nova is the film released in the West region overall.

Answer: B) The South film is released before the North film.

Solution: The full schedule is Onyx in Week 1 (East), Nova in Week 2 (South), Pulse in Week 3 (North) and Quill in Week 4 (West). The South film, Nova in Week 2, does come out before the North film, Pulse in Week 3, so that statement holds. The East film is in Week 1, not Week 2; Nova is the South film, not the West one; and Pulse in Week 3 is earlier than Quill in Week 4, so the other three are false.

Section: QA (suggested 36 min)

Q41. [QA-MCQ-1 · mcsc · diff 0]

A trader buys an article for Rs 800 and sells it for Rs 1000. What is his profit percentage?

- A) 22%
- B) 30%
- C) 20%
- D) 25% ✓

Answer: D) 25%

Solution: The profit is 1000 minus 800, which is 200, and profit percent uses cost price as the base, so 200 divided by 800 times 100 gives 25%. The 20% figure is the classic slip of dividing the 200 profit by the 1000 selling price instead of the 800 cost. The 30% and 22% values do not follow from any correct base.

Q42. [QA-MCQ-2 · mcsc · diff 0]

Three numbers are in the ratio 2 : 3 : 5 and their sum is 300. What is the largest of the three numbers?

- A) 60
- B) 90
- C) 150 ✓
- D) 100

Answer: C) 150

Solution: The ratio parts add up to 2 plus 3 plus 5, which is 10, so one part equals 300 divided by 10, that is 30, and the largest number is 5 parts, giving 150. The 100 value comes from wrongly splitting 300 into three equal pieces. The 90 and 60 values are the middle and smallest shares, not the largest.

Q43. [QA-MCQ-3 · mcsc · diff 0]

The average of five numbers is 18. When a sixth number is included, the average of all six numbers becomes 20. What is the sixth number?

- A) 22
- B) 30 ✓
- C) 38
- D) 20

Answer: B) 30

Solution: The five numbers total 5 times 18, which is 90, and the six numbers total 6 times 20, which is 120, so the sixth number is 120 minus 90, giving 30. The 20 value is the trap of assuming the extra number equals the new average. The 38 value comes from adding the two averages, and 22 has no valid basis.

Q44. [QA-MCQ-4 · mcsc · diff 0]

A bus travels at a constant speed of 54 km/h. How far does it travel in 40 minutes?

- A) 54 km
- B) 45 km
- C) 36 km ✓
- D) 40 km

Answer: C) 36 km

Solution: Forty minutes is 40 over 60 of an hour, that is two thirds, so distance is 54 times two thirds, giving 36 km. The 40 value wrongly reports the time in minutes as a distance. The 54 value ignores the time entirely and just repeats the speed, while 45 does not match any correct step.

Q45. [QA-MCQ-5 · mcsc · diff 0]

What is the smallest positive number that is divisible by both 8 and 12?

- A) 4
- B) 24 ✓
- C) 96
- D) 48

Answer: B) 24

Solution: The smallest common multiple is the LCM, found by dividing the product 96 by the HCF 4, which gives 24, and 24 is indeed divisible by both 8 and 12. The 96 value is the raw product of 8 and 12, which is a multiple but not the smallest. The 48 value is twice the answer, and 4 is the HCF, not a common multiple.

Q46. [QA-MCQ-6 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A can finish a piece of work in 10 days and B can finish the same work in 15 days. Working together, in how many days will they complete the work?

- A) 12.5
- B) 5
- C) 6 ✓
- D) 25

Answer: C) 6

Solution: In one day A does one tenth and B does one fifteenth, and their combined daily work is one tenth plus one fifteenth, which equals one sixth, so together they need 6 days. The 12.5 value comes from wrongly averaging 10 and 15. The 25 value adds the two times together, and 5 halves one of them without cause.

Q47. [QA-MCQ-7 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A sum of Rs 6250 is invested at 8% per annum, compounded annually. What is the compound interest earned after 2 years?

- A) Rs 1040 ✓
- B) Rs 1000
- C) Rs 1080
- D) Rs 500

Answer: A) Rs 1040

Solution: The amount after two years is 6250 times 1.08 times 1.08, which equals 7290, so the compound interest is 7290 minus 6250, giving Rs 1040. The Rs 1000 value is the simple interest for the same period and ignores interest on interest. The Rs 500 value is one year of simple interest, and Rs 1080 does not follow from any correct step.

Q48. [QA-MCQ-8 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In how many distinct ways can all the letters of the word LEVEL be arranged?

- A) 20
- B) 120
- C) 30 ✓
- D) 60

Answer: C) 30

Solution: LEVEL has five letters with L repeated twice and E repeated twice, so the count is 5 factorial divided by 2 factorial times 2 factorial, which is 120 divided by 4, giving 30. The 120 value treats all letters as distinct. The 60 value divides by only one pair of repeats, and 20 has no valid derivation.

Q49. [QA-MCQ-9 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A solid cylinder has radius 7 cm and height 10 cm. Taking $\pi = 22/7$, what is its volume?

- A) 1078 cubic cm
- B) 440 cubic cm
- C) 1540 cubic cm ✓
- D) 220 cubic cm

Answer: C) 1540 cubic cm

Solution: Volume of a cylinder is π times radius squared times height, that is 22 over 7 times 49 times 10, which simplifies to 22 times 7 times 10, giving 1540 cubic cm. The 1078 value wrongly uses the radius 7 in place of the height 10. The 440 value is the curved surface area 2 times π times radius times height, not the volume, and 220 uses radius to the first power.

Q50. [QA-MCQ-10 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

If $x + 1/x = 5$, what is the value of x squared plus $1/x$ squared?

- A) 23 ✓
- B) 27
- C) 10
- D) 25

Answer: A) 23

Solution: Squaring x plus 1 over x gives x squared plus 1 over x squared plus 2, and this equals 5 squared, that is 25, so x squared plus 1 over x squared is 25 minus 2, giving 23. The 25 value forgets to subtract the middle term 2. The 27 value adds 2 instead of subtracting, and 10 wrongly doubles the 5.

Q51. [QA-MCQ-11 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

What number should replace the question mark in the sequence 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?

- A) 42 ✓
- B) 44
- C) 40
- D) 36

Answer: A) 42

Solution: The gaps between terms are 4, 6, 8 and 10, increasing by 2 each time, so the next gap is 12 and the next term is 30 plus 12, giving 42. Each term also equals n times n plus 1, and the sixth is 6 times 7, which confirms 42. The 40 value wrongly repeats a gap of 10, while 36 and 44 fit no consistent pattern.

Q52. [QA-MCQ-12 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The difference between the compound interest and the simple interest on a certain sum for 2 years at 8% per annum is Rs 48. What is the sum?

- A) Rs 7,500 ✓
- B) Rs 9,600
- C) Rs 6,000
- D) Rs 8,000

Answer: A) Rs 7,500

Solution: For 2 years the gap between compound and simple interest equals P times $(r/100)$ squared, so P times $0.0064 = 48$, giving $P = 7500$. The 6,000 value drops the square, the 9,600 figure divides the wrong way, and 8,000 rounds the rate loosely.

Q53. [QA-MCQ-13 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In what ratio must a trader mix tea costing Rs 200 per kg with tea costing Rs 300 per kg so that the mixture costs Rs 240 per kg?

- A) 2 : 3
- B) 5 : 3
- C) 3 : 5
- D) 3 : 2 ✓

Answer: D) 3 : 2

Solution: By alligation the cheaper to dearer ratio is (300 minus 240) to (240 minus 200), which is 60 to 40, or 3 to 2. The 2 to 3 answer flips the two differences, while the 3 to 5 and 5 to 3 values compare against the wrong reference prices.

Q54. [QA-MCQ-14 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A can complete a task in 12 days and B in 18 days. They work together for 4 days, after which A leaves. In how many more days will B alone finish the remaining task?

- A) 9 days
- B) 6 days
- C) 8 days ✓
- D) 10 days

Answer: C) 8 days

Solution: Together they do $\frac{5}{36}$ of the task per day, so 4 days clears $\frac{2}{9}$ and leaves $\frac{4}{9}$. At B's rate of $\frac{1}{18}$ per day, $\frac{4}{9}$ divided by $\frac{1}{18}$ needs 8 more days. The 6 day value forgets the joint spell, and the 9 and 10 day figures misread the leftover fraction.

Q55. [QA-MCQ-15 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The circumference of a circle exceeds its diameter by 30 cm. Taking pi as $\frac{22}{7}$, what is the radius of the circle?

- A) 14 cm
 - B) 7 cm ✓
 - C) 10.5 cm
 - D) 5 cm
- Answer: B) 7 cm**

Solution: Circumference minus diameter is $2r$ times (pi minus 1), which equals $2r$ times $\frac{15}{7}$. Setting this to 30 gives $r = 7$. The 14 value doubles the radius, 10.5 treats the gap as the diameter, and 5 uses pi as 3 instead of $\frac{22}{7}$.

Q56. [QA-MCQ-16 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

How many 3-digit numbers with no repeated digit and formed only from the digits 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 are even?

- A) 12
- B) 20
- C) 36
- D) 24 ✓

Answer: D) 24

Solution: The units place must be 2 or 4, giving 2 choices, and the first two places take 4 then 3 of the remaining digits, so 2 times 12 equals 24. The 12 value fixes only one even ending, 36 ignores the no-repeat rule, and 20 miscounts the leading places.

Q57. [QA-MCQ-17 · mcsc · diff 1]

How many positive divisors of 3600 are perfect squares?

- A) 12 ✓
- B) 27
- C) 18
- D) 45

Answer: A) 12

Solution: Since 3600 factors as 2^4 times 3^2 times 5^2 , a square divisor needs even exponents: 3 choices for the power of 2 and 2 each for 3 and 5, so 3 times 2 times 2 equals 12. The 45 value counts every divisor, 27 wrongly uses 3 options for each prime, and 18 mixes the counts.

Q58. [QA-MCQ-18 · mcsc · diff 1]

If a and b are the roots of the equation $2x^2 - 5x + 1 = 0$, what is the value of $a/b + b/a$?

- A) $23/2$
- B) $19/2$
- C) $25/2$
- D) $21/2$ ✓

Answer: D) $21/2$

Solution: The expression equals $(a^2 + b^2)$ over ab , which is $((a+b)^2 - 2ab)$ over ab . With sum $5/2$ and product $1/2$, this is $(25/4 - 1)$ divided by $1/2$, giving $21/2$. The $25/2$ value skips subtracting $2ab$, and $23/2$ and $19/2$ mishandle the product term.

Q59. [QA-MCQ-19 · mcsc · diff 1]

A bag holds 5 red balls and 4 blue balls. Three balls are drawn together at random. What is the probability that at least one of them is blue?

- A) $37/42$ ✓
- B) $5/6$
- C) $5/42$
- D) $10/21$

Answer: A) $37/42$

Solution: The complement is drawing three reds, which is $10/84$, so the answer is 1 minus $10/84$ equals $74/84$, or $37/42$. The $5/42$ value is the all-red probability itself, $10/21$ doubles it, and $5/6$ estimates without exact counting.

Q60. [QA-MCQ-20 · mcsc · diff 1]

A vessel contains 80 litres of pure milk. 8 litres are drawn off and replaced with water, and then the same operation is performed once more. How much milk is now in the vessel?

- A) 64 litres
- B) 64.8 litres ✓
- C) 72 litres
- D) 65.6 litres

Answer: B) 64.8 litres

Solution: After each replacement the milk is scaled by $72/80$, so after two rounds it is 80 times $(9/10)$ squared, which is 80 times 0.81 equals 64.8 litres. The 65.6 value subtracts 8 twice, 64 applies the ratio only once as 0.8, and 72 removes 8 litres just one time.

Q61. [QA-MCQ-21 · mcsc · diff 1]

What is the sum of the first 20 terms of the series $1 + 3 + 6 + 10 + 15 + \dots$, whose n -th term is the n -th triangular number?

- A) 1240
- B) 1330
- C) 1450
- D) 1540 ✓

Answer: D) 1540

Solution: Each term is $n(n+1)/2$, so the total is half the sum of n^2 plus n for n up to 20, which is half of $(2870 + 210)$ equals 1540. The 1240 and 1450 values misadd the two component sums, and 1330 stops one term short at n equal to 19.

Q62. [QA-MCQ-22 · mcsc · diff 1]

N is a two-digit number. Consider two statements. I: The sum of the digits of N is 12. II: N exceeds the number formed by reversing its digits by 36. Which statements are needed to determine N uniquely?

- A) Both statements together are needed, not either alone ✓
- B) Statement II about the reversal alone is sufficient here
- C) Either statement, used on its own, is enough to decide
- D) Statement I about the digit sum alone is sufficient here

Answer: A) Both statements together are needed, not either alone

Solution: Statement I allows 39, 48, 57 and more, and statement II gives $9(a - b)$ equal to 36 so $a - b$ is 4 with many pairs, so each alone leaves several numbers. Combining $a + b$ equal 12 with $a - b$ equal 4 fixes a equal 8 and b equal 4, giving 84 as the only value.

Section: General Awareness (suggested 16 min)

Q63. [GA-1 · mcsc · diff 0]

In India, which honour is regarded as the highest government award for lifetime contribution to cinema?

- A) National Film Award
- B) Dadasaheb Phalke Award ✓
- C) IIFA Excellence Award
- D) Filmfare Best Film Award

Answer: B) Dadasaheb Phalke Award

Solution: The Dadasaheb Phalke Award, named after the pioneer of Indian cinema, is conferred by the government for lifetime achievement. The Filmfare and IIFA prizes are industry trophies, and the National Film Award covers many yearly categories rather than a single lifetime honour.

Q64. [GA-2 · mcsc · diff 0]

Which set of awards is the most prominent recognition of excellence in television programming?

- A) The Academy Awards
- B) The Grammy Awards
- C) The Emmy Awards ✓
- D) The Tony Awards

Answer: C) The Emmy Awards

Solution: The Emmy Awards honour achievement in television. The Tony Awards recognise live theatre, the Grammy Awards celebrate the music recording industry, and the Academy Awards reward cinema, so none of those fits television.

Q65. [GA-3 · mcsc · diff 0]

Studio Ghibli, the animation house behind films such as "Spirited Away", is based in which country?

- A) China
- B) Japan ✓
- C) South Korea
- D) United States

Answer: B) Japan

Solution: Studio Ghibli is a celebrated Japanese animation studio co-founded by Hayao Miyazaki. The other options name countries with their own animation traditions, but Ghibli's hand-drawn features are produced in Japan.

Q66. [GA-4 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In film and music, the abbreviation "OST" most commonly stands for:

- A) Optical sound test
- B) Official studio take
- C) Original soundtrack ✓
- D) Orchestral score tape

Answer: C) Original soundtrack

Solution: OST stands for original soundtrack, the collection of music released from a film, series or game. The other expansions borrow real audio terms but are not what the industry abbreviation denotes.

Q67. [GA-5 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In India, which statutory body certifies films for public exhibition?

- A) National Film Development Corporation
- B) Central Board of Film Certification ✓
- C) Press Council of India
- D) Film and Television Institute of India

Answer: B) Central Board of Film Certification

Solution: The Central Board of Film Certification issues the U, UA, A and S certificates required for theatrical release. The institute at Pune trains filmmakers, the development corporation finances films, and the press council handles print media, so none of them certifies films.

Q68. [GA-6 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Doordarshan and All India Radio operate under which public broadcasting body?

- A) Films Division of India
- B) National Book Trust
- C) Sangeet Natak Akademi
- D) Prasar Bharati ✓

Answer: D) Prasar Bharati

Solution: Prasar Bharati is the autonomous public service broadcaster that runs Doordarshan and All India Radio. The other bodies work in performing arts, documentary filmmaking and publishing respectively, not broadcasting.

Q69. [GA-7 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In the entertainment industry, the Tony Awards are the highest honours in which field?

- A) Recorded music
- B) Network television
- C) Broadway theatre ✓
- D) Feature films

Answer: C) Broadway theatre

Solution: The Tony Awards honour excellence in Broadway theatre; network television is recognised by the Emmy Awards, feature films by the Academy Awards, and recorded music by the Grammy Awards.

Q70. [GA-8 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In film and visual effects work, the abbreviation "CGI" stands for:

- A) Colour grading instrument
- B) Cinematic graphics interface
- C) Central gaming index
- D) Computer-generated imagery ✓

Answer: D) Computer-generated imagery

Solution: CGI means computer-generated imagery, the digitally created visuals used for effects, creatures and environments. The other expansions mix in real production terms but do not match the abbreviation.

Q71. [GA-9 · mcsc · diff 1]

The show-business term "EGOT" describes a person who has won all four of which awards?

- A) Emmy, Grammy, Oscar and BAFTA
- B) Emmy, Golden Globe, Oscar and Tony
- C) Emmy, Grammy, Obie and Tony
- D) Emmy, Grammy, Oscar and Tony ✓

Answer: D) Emmy, Grammy, Oscar and Tony

Solution: EGOT is an acronym for winning the Emmy, Grammy, Oscar and Tony, covering television, music, film and theatre. The variants swap in the Golden Globe, BAFTA or Obie, none of which is part of the classic EGOT quartet.

Q72. [GA-10 · mcsc · diff 1]

The Clio Awards are among the most prestigious international honours in which creative field?

- A) Architecture
- B) Advertising ✓
- C) Journalism
- D) Photography

Answer: B) Advertising

Solution: The Clio Awards recognise excellence in advertising and creative communications; photography, journalism, and architecture each have their own separate honours.